KEY TAKEAWAYS

- There was an anxiety on the kind of impact the Ayodhya verdict would have on the body politic of the country but not of the political kind
- The executive, legislature and judiciary are separated in their functions and powers but are not separated in their objectives
- There was nothing political about the Ayodha or Rafale case
- Media responsible for blowing up issues of the judiciary

It is a difficult place to be in, the Chief Justice of India, and it is a heavy responsibility. There is too much competition for the court's ears. Obviously everyone wants to win his case... the problem really arises from the somewhat irresponsible comments judges have to face

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We are not involved in politics. We decide a case that comes up before us, brought to us by parties who have something to say, who have a claim. We adjudicate that claim. What is the politics in that?

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I consider it perfectly legitimate that the executive has a vital interest in who is going to be a judge. The problem is not that the executive has an interest, the problem is how to give effect to that interest.... I don't support the cause that the executive should not have a say. But they should not have veto power. The primacy of opinion must be that of the judiciary



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gitimate given that the government was a party in the bulk of litigation. But he was also clear that the collegium system of appointing judges was the ideal one. Justice Bobde also recalled the most difficult cases he had adjudicated on. He also suggested that many of the issues pertaining to the court that the public frets over are born out of irresponsible comments by the media. On a lighter note, the justice, an avid biker, also cleared the air on the Harley Davidson incident during the Covid pandemic. ■